

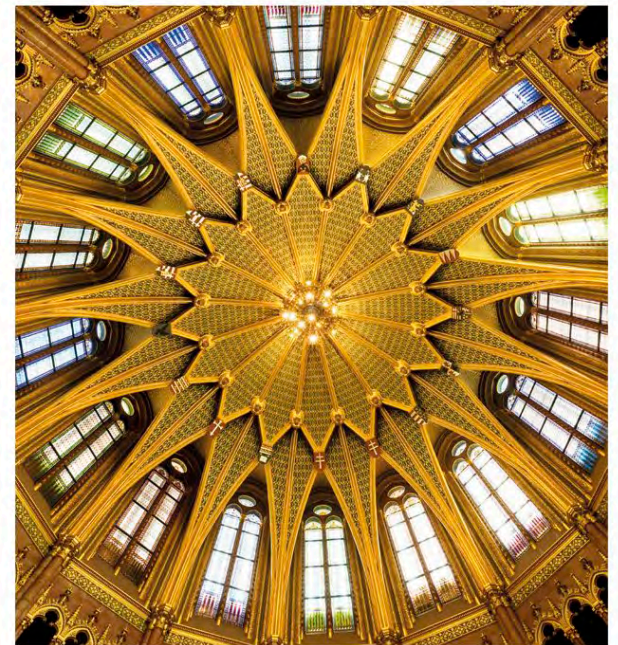


◁ IMPRESSIVE FACADE

The Parliament Building revels in an eclectic mix of architectural styles, its Gothic spires and pointed arches capped by a Renaissance-style dome. The facade overlooking the Danube River is 880 ft (268 m) long.

▽ CENTRAL DOME

The interior of the building's central dome is lavishly decorated. Beneath the dome lies a 16-sided hall that houses an exhibition of royal regalia, including the 12th-century Crown of St. Stephen once used for the coronation of Hungarian monarchs.



Hungarian Parliament Building

An architectural splendor on the bank of the Danube in Budapest that reflects the golden age of the Hungarian nation



Erected between 1884 and 1904, the Hungarian Parliament Building is a dazzling expression of the confidence and prosperity of the city of Budapest at the time. Recognized as equal partners in the dual monarchy of Austria–Hungary, the Hungarians were experiencing a national revival. The architect chosen for the project was a Hungarian, Imre Steindl (1839–1902), and almost every piece of material used in the building's construction was sourced in Hungary. It was embellished with 88 statues of historic Hungarian rulers.

Grand scale

The Gothic Revival style of the long facade is an homage to London's Palace of Westminster (see opposite), but the scale of the building is much larger. Its construction and decoration required 40 million

bricks, about half a million precious stones, and some 88lb (40 kg) of gold. One of the building's two parliament halls is still in use as a National Assembly. The other, the richly decorated Chamber of Peers, is open to tourists, who can also view the Hungarian crown jewels, now displayed in the Dome Hall. Since 1987, the Parliament Building has been part of a UNESCO World Heritage Site that also includes the Buda Castle quarter on the opposite bank of the Danube River and the 19th-century Chain Bridge that crosses the river.

The **dome** of the Parliament Building is **315 ft (96 m) tall**